The Language Page Activity Guide: Grades 6–8

How to use these activities

Each page that follows is one activity for Grades 6–8: what it is, how students use it, what feedback they get, and how to teach it.

1. **Open the link.** No account is needed to practice. Your work saves in this browser on this device. Share the link, or let students find the activity from the More menu.
2. **Choose help.** Most activities ask first how much help a student wants, such as frames and words, a word bank, or on my own. Some also offer more help along the way.
3. **Feedback is not a score.** The checks look for words and patterns, not meaning. Nothing on these pages is an ACCESS score or a WIDA level.
4. **Recording is optional.** A microphone is never required. Recording starts only when a person presses Record, and recordings stay in the open tab.
5. **Work saves on the device.** Saved work stays on the device and browser you used. It does not follow you to a different device, and clearing site data removes it. Passport can export it.

All activities and handouts

thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/start

The start page links to the tour, the exploration, the featured lesson, these guides and the Site Guide.

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Recycling Benefits: Listen for the Main Idea Listening

Where: The Sound Studio · Building support · **Time:** 6 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/Listening/B/main-idea-match-b?grades=6-8

What it is. Students listen to a short teacher statement and choose what it is mostly about.

Why it works

A short spoken statement and three choices let students practice one move, telling the big idea from a single detail, with the audio as slow and as often as they need.

How to open it. Share the link; it opens at the right grade. Students can also choose Listening under "Start by skill" on the lab home.

How students use it

1. Read the direction under Warm up. "Hear directions" reads it aloud, and "Key words" lists the words to know.
2. If the short skill lesson opens, read the three moves, then press "Got it, let me try."
3. Press "Listen." Try "Slower," then press "Hear question." "Word help" explains four words.
4. Choose an answer, then how sure you are: "Guessing," "I think so" or "Sure."
5. Press "Check my answer." If it says "Not yet — try again," read "One next step," then press "Try again" or "Show me the model."

Feedback students get

"Not yet — try again" with "What went well" and "One next step," or a confirmation. "Show me the model" is there when a student wants it. No score.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- "Listen," "Slower" and "Hear question."
- Word help ("Ayuda con palabras").
- A two-minute skill lesson on the main idea, with a worked model.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- After checking, students say the detail that proves the main idea.

> **Good to know.** Help and retries are saved as supported practice. The page says it is practice evidence, not a proficiency score.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Model the question: "What is this mostly about?"	Students choose, then name one detail they heard.	Ask why "Cans are made of metal." is a detail, not the main idea.

If something goes wrong

No sound	Check the device volume. Read the direction and the choices aloud yourself; the pictures still work.
Students pick a single fact	Reread the skill lesson's "Watch out": one small fact is not the main idea.

The Busy Hallway Speaking

Where: Voice Lab · Picture speaking ladder · **Time:** 5–8 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/voice/ladder/school-hallway

What it is. Students look at a hallway picture and speak three times: name things, say what is happening and why, then explain one change and give a reason.

Why it works

Students say one idea at three lengths, so they rehearse words before sentences and sentences before an explanation. Hearing a classmate-style model first shows what a complete answer sounds like.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Voice Lab, then "The Busy Hallway."

How students use it

1. Look at the hallway picture.
2. Step 1 · Words: tap "Hear the question," then "Hear Amara first" to hear a model answer.
3. Say four things you see. Open "Show a sentence frame" if you want help.
4. Optional: press "Record my answer," then listen to yourself. Or say it to a partner.
5. Press "I said it out loud." Then do Step 2 · Sentences and Step 3 · Tell more the same way.

Feedback students get

No score. A model student to compare with, and a length meter after a recording. Steps marked "said" are remembered on this device.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- A model student you can hear before you answer (device voice).
- A sentence frame under "Show a sentence frame."
- Optional recording: the microphone is requested only when you press Record.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Partners listen instead of recording.
- Students plan in their home language first.

> **Good to know.** Not scored. Recordings stay in the open tab and are never uploaded. "I said it out loud" is remembered on this device.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Show the picture and model Step 1 yourself.	Partners take turns; the listener holds up a finger for each detail or reason they hear.	Ask two students to say their Step 3 answer to the class.

If something goes wrong

No sound from "Hear …"	Check the volume. The voice is the device's own; read the model aloud instead.
No microphone, or students do not want to record	Skip Record. Say it to a partner, then press "I said it out loud."

Speak at the School Board Meeting Speaking

Where: Speaking Studio · **Time:** 7 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/speak/spk-startime-argue

What it is. Students read a short survey table, plan a position with two pieces of evidence, say it, and review it.

Why it works

Students plan with evidence before they speak, then see their own words written out, so the second try can be clearer and better supported than the first.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Speaking Studio, then "Speak at the School Board Meeting."

How students use it

1. Read the situation and the survey table. Tap "Hear the task" to hear the directions.
2. Choose your help: "With frames and words," "With a word bank," or "On my own."
3. Plan: write your position, two pieces of evidence and one concern.
4. Say it: press "Record my answer," or "I said it out loud (no recording)."
5. Type it: fix or type the words you said. Then read the Coach notes, and use Review to say it again if you want.

Feedback students get

Coach notes that look at the words students said or typed (not pronunciation). No score; the page says it is practice, not an ACCESS score.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- Three help levels: frames and words, a word bank only, or on my own.
- "Hear the task" reads the directions aloud.
- Record an answer, or press "I said it out loud (no recording)." Typing the words is always possible.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- A partner plays the school board and asks one question.
- Students rehearse once before recording.

> **Good to know.** Practice, not a score. The Coach looks at the words students say or type, not at pronunciation.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Read the table together and point to the two numbers that matter most.	Small groups of three: a speaker, a board member who asks one question, and a listener.	Each listener names one number they heard in the speech.

If something goes wrong

Speech-to-text did not catch the words	Type the words in "Type it." Typing always works.
The student is stuck on the plan	Switch to "With frames and words" to see sentence frames and a model.

🕮 Saving Water: Find the Main Idea Reading

Where: The Reading Atelier · Starting support · **Time:** 8 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/Reading/A/read-main-idea?grades=6-8

What it is. Students read a short informational text and choose what it is mostly about.

Why it works

A short informational text and three choices let students practice one move, telling the main idea from a small fact, and check it against the other sentences.

How to open it. Share the link; it opens at the right grade. Students can also choose Reading under “Start by skill” on the lab home.

How students use it

1. Read the direction under Warm up. “Hear directions” reads it aloud, and “Key words” lists the words to know.
2. If the short skill lesson opens, read the three moves, then press “Got it, let me try.”
3. Read the short text. Open “Word help” for any of its five words.
4. Choose an answer, then how sure you are: “Guessing,” “I think so” or “Sure.”
5. Press “Check my answer.” If it says “Not yet — try again,” read “One next step,” then press “Try again” or “Show me the model.”

Feedback students get

“Not yet — try again” with “What went well” and “One next step,” or a confirmation. “Show me the model” is there when a student wants it. No score.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- Word help (“Ayuda con palabras”).
- A two-minute skill lesson on the main idea, with a worked model.
- “Learn with help” or “Try independently.”

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Students underline the sentence that proves the main idea.

> **Good to know.** Help and retries are saved as supported practice. The page says it is practice evidence, not a proficiency score.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Model the three moves on a short paragraph of your own.	Students choose, then underline the proof.	Ask why the backpack choice is a detail, not the main idea.

If something goes wrong

A word blocks the meaning	Open “Word help” for that word.
Students pick a single fact	Ask: do the other sentences explain that idea?

Language Upgrade Lab Writing

Where: Language builders · **Time:** 5 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/scaffold/language-upgrade?item=lu68-argue-phones

What it is. Students revise a plain sentence ("Phones in class are bad.") by adding a detail, a more exact word and a connector.

Why it works

One sentence is small enough to revise several times in five minutes. The three checks turn "make it better" into three concrete moves: a detail, an exact word, a connector.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Language builders, then Language Upgrade Lab.

How students use it

1. Read the everyday sentence: "Phones in class are bad."
2. Choose "Start with this help" (a frame and a word bank) or "On my own."
3. Write a better version under "My revision."
4. Press "Check my work." It shows Before and After and three checks: a detail, a precise word, two ideas connected.
5. Fix what it names and check again. "Ask for more help" adds a model if you are stuck.

Feedback students get

Three checks marked "not yet" or met, with what to fix. It looks for words and connectors; it does not judge meaning. Every revision is kept.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- A sentence frame and a word bank ("Start with this help"), or nothing at all ("On my own").
- "Ask for more help" adds support and marks the try as supported.
- "Check my work" names what to fix; students can revise as many times as they like.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Read the frame aloud together before writing.
- Partners swap sentences and underline the exact word.

> **Good to know.** The check looks for a detail, an exact word and a connector. It does not judge meaning.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Read the frame aloud and model one exact word for "bad."	Students check, then compare their exact word with a partner.	Collect three revised sentences and read them aloud.

If something goes wrong

"Not yet" on every check	Use the frame: "Phones in class can be ___ because ___." and one word from the bank.
A student wants no help	Choose "On my own." Opening help later marks the try as supported, which is fine.

Should School Start Later? Writing

Where: Writing Studio · **Time:** 20 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/write/wrt-school-start-paragraph

What it is. Students read a school-board situation, a short article and a survey table, plan, write one paragraph that takes a position, then revise after feedback.

Why it works

Reading the sources and planning first gives students something to say. Feedback that points at their own sentences leads to one specific revision instead of a rewrite.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Writing Studio, then "Should School Start Later?"

How students use it

1. Read: the Student Council Notes and the Student Sleep Survey. "Read aloud" reads a source to you.
2. Choose your help: "With frames and words," "With a word bank," or "On my own." Tap a sentence to add it to your evidence notebook.
3. Plan: position, two reasons with evidence, the other side, your answer to it.
4. Write: one paragraph (about 80–150 words). It saves on this device as you type.
5. Feedback: press "Get feedback," revise, then Finish.

Feedback students get

Feedback describes what is on the page (evidence used, connectors, sentence shapes) and never gives a score. The first draft is kept so growth is visible.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- Three help levels, from frames and words to on my own.
- "Hear the task" and "Read aloud" for the sources; "Read my writing to me."
- Sentence frames, a word bank, Spanish and word-part bridges, and a model response.
- Writing is saved on this device as students type.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Students talk through their two reasons with a partner before writing.
- Use one rubric row for feedback, not all of them.

> **Good to know.** Feedback describes what is on the page and never gives a score.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Day 1: read and plan together. Model the position sentence with the first frame.	Day 2: write, then one round of "Get feedback" and one revision.	Partners read paragraphs aloud and say which reason is strongest.

If something goes wrong

The paragraph feels too long for the time	Write only the position sentence and one reason today; finish tomorrow. The draft is saved.
A student needs vocabulary	Open "Word meanings and Spanish" for word bridges, or "See a model response."

🕮 Why Do We Have Seasons? Reading

Where: Reading Room · **Time:** 12 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/reading-room/rr68p-why-we-have-seasons

What it is. Students read a short explanation text, mark paragraphs, open word help and answer questions.

Why it works

A short text with word help and paragraph marks builds the ideas and vocabulary students then speak and write about.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Reading Room, then find "Why Do We Have Seasons?" on the shelf.

How students use it

1. Choose Learn, Practice or Independent challenge at the top.
2. Read "Before you read." Open a word under "Words to notice" if you need its meaning.
3. Read each paragraph. "Read passage aloud" reads it to you; you can choose the speed.
4. Use "Mark this paragraph" and write a note. "Save reading place" keeps your spot.
5. In "Your response," work through 1 · Understand, 2 · Investigate and 3 · Apply, pressing "Check answer" on each question. "Write about a text" and "Speak about a text" lead on.

Feedback students get

"Check answer" on each question. Notes, marks and answers save in this browser ("Save lesson progress"). Not a score.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- Read aloud with a device voice, optional word help, paragraph marks and notes, text size and spacing. "Write about a text" and "Speak about a text" lead on to speaking and writing.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Use the before, during and after ideas below.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Ask: what do you think causes summer?	Partners mark the paragraph that corrects the wrong idea.	Students explain the cause with "because" and "so."

If something goes wrong

The text is hard	Use Read together or Practice mode and the word help.

Aa Morpheme Builder Vocabulary

Where: Word Lab · **Time:** 5–10 min · **Link:** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/wordlab/build

What it is. Students snap prefixes, roots and suffixes together to build a word from its meaning.

Why it works

Knowing prefixes, roots and suffixes helps students work out new academic words and choose more exact words when they write.

How to open it. Share the link. Students can also open the More menu, choose Word Lab, then Morpheme Builder.

How students use it

1. Choose your help: A More support, B Some support or C On my own.
2. Choose “Build it” (make a word from a meaning) or “Decode it” (find the parts).
3. Read the meaning, then tap a prefix, a root and a suffix to snap them together.
4. Press “Check my word.” When it matches, the page says “You built …” and shows what each part means. “Clear” starts the word again.
5. Press “Next word.” The counter shows how many words you have built. Nothing is timed.

Feedback students get

A built word is confirmed with the meaning of each part, and “Hear it” says the word. Not a score.

Built-in help (part of the activity)

- Three support levels (More, Some, On my own), “Show what the parts mean,” and “Hear it.” Nothing is timed or scored.

Teaching moves (what you add)

- Use the before, during and after ideas below.

Teach it

Before	During	After
Model one word: ex- + port = export.	Partners say each word they build in a sentence.	Use one new word in the Language Upgrade Lab.

If something goes wrong

Too many choices	Choose A More support.